



IIT ROORKEE



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CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 26: Paralanguage

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“Words mean more than what is set down on paper. It takes the human voice to infuse them with shades of deeper meaning.”

- Maya Angelou in *I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings*



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Vocalics

- ❑ Paralanguage is otherwise known as Vocalics.
- ❑ The name suggests the study of voice in relation to the language of speech.
- ❑ The field was opened by American linguist George L. Trager.
- ❑ The role of voice plays crucial role in:
 - Transference of emotions.
 - Conveying the relevance and importance of idea.
 - Constructing and supporting the generated meaning.



Tone
Rate
Volume
Pace

Language of Voice

- ❖ The role of voice plays a pivotal role in delivering the intention behind the message.
- ❖ Intention reveals not just the idea, but also the emotional value.
- ❖ Thus, a proper message delivered in a suitable voice creates a larger effect.
- ❖ For an effective voice, proper training is needed for smooth articulation and clear pronunciation.

"I didn't **SAY** you were stupid."
"I didn't say **YOU** were stupid."
"I didn't say you were **STUPID**."

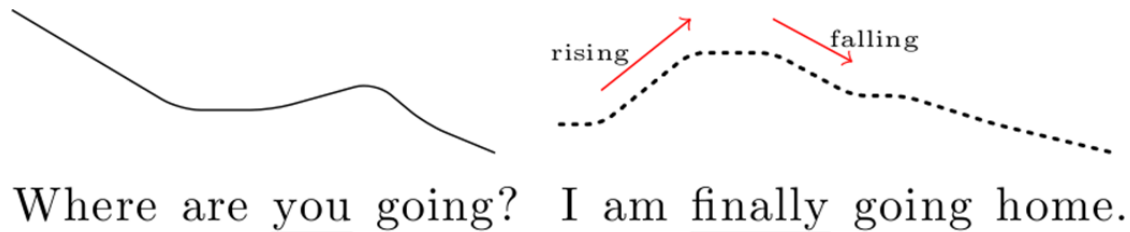
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Voice and Emotions

- ❑ Research findings suggest the following criteria such as:
 - Speaker's intonation
 - Prosody
 - Vocal effort
 - Speaking rate
- ❑ Voice has the potential to reflect the speaker's emotional state (Nygaard and Lunders 583).
- ❑ Lexical ambiguities of the spoken word are bridged by proper equipment of the above-enlisted speech techniques.
- ❑ The delivery of emotions appropriates the speaker's intention to the audience with much more precision.

Intonation

- ❖ It refers to the pattern of pitch variation in particular.
- ❖ The speaker's effort to shift the pitch with each utterance of a word offers detailed information to the listener.
- ❖ The speech melody of a person's utterance is intonation.
- ❖ In English, the intonation is usually observed in the dichotomy of rising and falling.



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Determinants of Paralanguage

- Ferdinand Poyatos in his book *Non-Verbal Communication across Disciplines* mentions different factors determining vocalics:

Biological

- Sex
- Age
- Vocal band size

Physiological

- Long-term malfunctions
- Pitch disorders
- Traumatized states

Psychological

- Loudness of extroversion
- Manic-phase Depression

Occupational

- Voice variation dynamics in professional world.

Sociocultural

- Cultural stereotypes and styles.

Features of voice

Volume

Rate

Pitch

Pronunciation

Silence and Pauses



Pitch



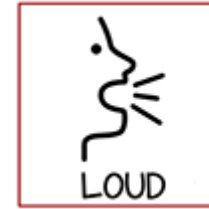
Volume



Pace

Volume of Voice

- Loudness
 - Softness
- } Intonation
- Voice level variation sense
 - Audible and clear
 - Acoustic awareness and amplification
 - Ensure your voice is engaging and not imposing
 - Keep the volume of your voice in control



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voice levels

0	no talking
1	"spy talk"
2	partnership & small group
3	normal voice
4	presenter
5	outside

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Pronunciation

- ❖ Proper pronunciation is usually determined by effective articulatory control.
- ❖ “Ideal articulatory voice control is of a slow tempo, anything under it would qualify as over slow, unnatural control” (Poyatos 52).
- ❖ Pronunciation control depends on the following four body parts:
 - Laryngeal
 - Pharyngeal
 - Lingual
 - Labio-facial
- ❖ International Phonetic Alphabet (IPA) is prescribed for accurate pronunciation.

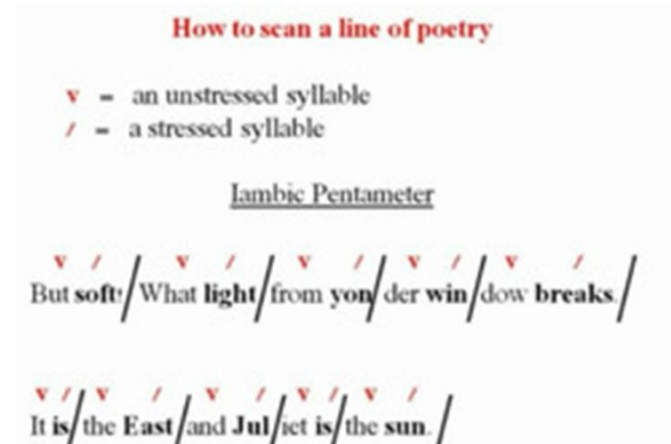
Rate of Speech Delivery

- ❖ An ideal delivery should neither be too fast nor too slow.
- ❖ The primary purpose of the speech shall be achieved at a controlled pace.
- ❖ However, the rate can be slowed down if the topic is relatively new or complex to the audience.
- ❖ Audience awareness is essential to determine the rate of delivery.
- ❖ Time duration of the presentation should also be considered.

130 to 150 words
per minute is
ideal.

Pitch Vibration

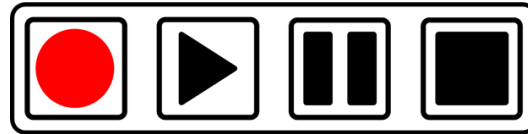
- ❖ Vocal Cord Vibration - Production of sounds
- ❖ Inflections
- ❖ Feelings
- ❖ Pitch variation is essential for the speaker to avoid being monotonous.
- ❖ Stress in sounds is integral during an oration.



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Silence and Pauses

- ❑ A point of separation/break/shift from one topic to another.
- ❑ Elongated pause results into a silence.
- ❑ Silence is a non-verbal cue.
- ❑ Silence as a form of communication has various implications with respect to the culture addressed.

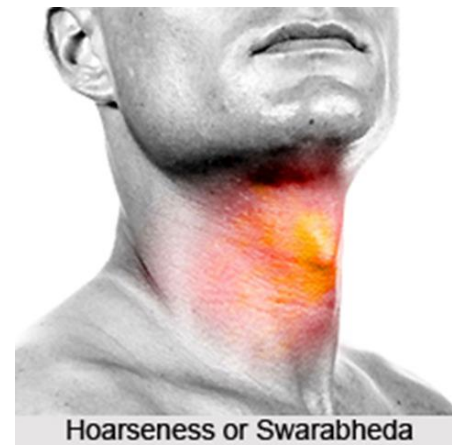


Advantages of Silence

- ✓ Thought process
- ✓ Reactions
- ✓ Introspection
- ✓ Decision making

Common Lapses in Articulation

- ❖ **Throatiness:** Deep resonance in your voice
- ❖ **Breathiness:** Passage of too much air through vocal cords
- ❖ **Nasalization:** Releasing air through the nose
- ❖ **Harshness:** Inhibited flow of air
- ❖ **Muffled:** Lazy lip and jaw movements
- ❖ **Hoarseness:** Inflammation of larynx (voice-box)



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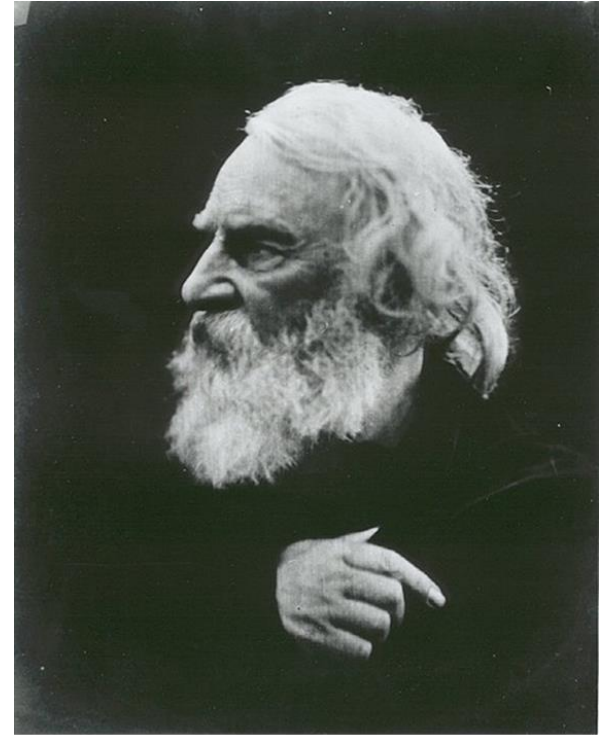
Conclusion

- ❖ Paralanguage, as the name suggests, is not just an aid for the language but essentially supports the speaker's idea and intention.
- ❖ Paralanguage posits itself as a perfect tool for persuasion.
- ❖ A vocal person seems to present himself as more confident and bold.
- ❖ Human voice reflects human emotions, as Longfellow once said that the “human soul is audible; not visible”.
- ❖ A voice filled with genuine emotion is capable of forming and connecting social bonds easily.

“ O how wonderful is the human voice! It is indeed the organ of the soul. The intellect of man sits enshrined visibly upon his forehead and in his eye; and the heart of man is written upon his countenance. But the soul reveals itself in the voice only, as God revealed himself to the prophet in the still small voice, and in a voice from the Burning Bush. The soul of man is audible, not visible. A sound alone betrays the flowing of the eternal fountain invisible to man.”

- H.W. Longfellow in *Hyperion*

Thank You



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